

Jacob Howard

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Fields of Research

International Trade, Production Networks, Innovation Economics, and Industrial Organization

Employment

MITRE, 2020-Present

Principal Economist: Commerce Department (2024-Present)

Lead Economist: Transportation Performance and Economic Analysis (2020-2023)

University of Colorado, Boulder 2014-2020

Instructor and Teaching Assistant

Research Assistant: McGuire Center for International Studies

NBER, 2016-2018

Research Assistant, NSF Grant: Trading, Institutions, Product Innovation, and Entrepreneurship

Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of Colorado at Boulder, May 2020

Dissertation: Essays on Endogenous Production-Network Formation and the Consequences of Globalization

Primary Advisor: Wolfgang Keller, Committee: Jeronimo Carballo, Keith Maskus, Sergey Nigai

M.A. Economics, University of Colorado at Boulder, 2016

M.A. Economics, University of Memphis, 2014

B.A. Economics, International Studies and Economics, University of Memphis, 2012

Minor: Mandarin; Study Abroad: Fudan University, Shanghai China 2011

Refereed Publications

The Impacts of Intellectual-Property Related Preferential Trade Agreements on Bilateral Patent Applications (2025)

Review of International Economics, vol. 33(2), pages 466-485

Joint with Keith Maskus and William Ridley

Regional Heterogeneity in Environmental Quality: The Role of Firm Production Networks and Trade (2024)

Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, vol. 11(5), pages 1311-1349

Joint with Doyoung Park and William Ridley

Working Papers

Effects of U.S. Export Controls on Chinese Firms

Joint with Mark Albertson and Miguel Sarzosa

Derisking in the Time of Decoupling: U.S. Critical Supply Chains and Reliance on China

Joint with Aspen Underwood

Labor-Market Frictions and Endogenous Production-Network Formation

Text2Trade: A Semantic Search System with Monte Carlo Dropout Uncertainty Quantification for HS Code Retrieval

Joint with Meenu Ravi, Grace Kenneally, and Ari Fleischer

Other Publications

Intellectual Property-Related PTAs and Patenting (2023)

Beyond Trade: How Deep Trade Agreements Shape Non-Trade Outcomes

CEPR Joint with Keith Maskus and William Ridley

De-Risking U.S. Supply Chains in the Era of Decoupling (2024)

MITRE Joint with Aspen Underwood

Current Research

Business is in the Air: Air Travel and the Formation of Firm Relationships in the United States

Joint with Alex Luttmann

The Spatial Propagation of Wage Inequality

Joint with Sergey Nigai

Uyghur Forced Labor Prevention Act and Global Trade in Textile Supply Chains

Joint with Alex Luttmann

Open Grants and Research Projects

Principal Investigator: The Impact of Offshoring and Outsourcing Firm Behaviors on Labor Market Outcomes

FSRDC Census Project hosted at Georgetown's Massive Data Institute

This project proposes to answer the following questions: What role do supply chains play in shaping wage inequality? How do these supply chains vary by firm productivity levels, and is there a systematic differential response of these supply chains to an international trade shock? If wages are determined by supply chains, this implies that there will be nominal wage consequences for workers in all sectors of the importing economy. How much do changes, due to trade shocks, in firm-level supply-chains spillover into non-import competing sectors? Within all sectors are there heterogeneous responses to trade shocks that vary by firm size and what are the implications of this heterogeneity?

Recent Conference and Seminar Activities, Including Upcoming

2026: U.S. Air Force Academy Economics Department Seminar, Department of Commerce Policy Evaluation Brown Bag (EBB&FLOW), Society of Government Economists Annual Conference, Hopkins-Georgetown Geoeconomics Conference, Western Economic Association International Annual Conference

2025: Washington and Lee University Economics Department Seminar

2024: USITC Office of Economics International Trade Seminar Series, Southern Economics Association Annual Meeting, Midwestern International Trade and Economic Theory Conference, Federal Statistical Research Data Center Annual Conference, NBER Summer Institute, NBER Corporate Partners Meeting, Society of Government Economists Annual Meeting

2023: North American Empirical Investigations in International Trade Conference, MITRE Economics Conference, Midwestern International Trade and Economic Theory Conference, Washington Area International Trade Symposium

2022: World Bank Deep Trade Agreements Conference

Public Speaking

State Department East Asia Pacific China Workshop: Critical Minerals Strategy and Cooperation (March 2026)-*Panelist*

NABE Policy Conference: Policy Frameworks for Fostering Resiliency in Supply Chains (February 2026)-*Panelist*

CSIS Federal Statistics For Economic Security (November 2025)-*Roundtable Moderator*

NBER Resilience in Supply Chains Conference (December 2024)-*Panelist*

Awards, Fellowships

MITRE Awards:

Trailblazer Award 2024
Synergist Award 2024
Applause Awards, 2024, 2023, 2021
Spark Awards, 2024, 2023 (3x), 2021 (2x)
Catalyst Award, MITRE Dollar Dominance Project, 2021
Project Recognition Award- Project Redacted, 2021

University of Colorado at Boulder:

Morris E. Garnsey Fellowship in Economics, 2018
Sieglinde Talbott Haller Economics Scholarship, 2017
Leslie Whittington Memorial Fellowship for Excellence in Economics, 2016

Yordon Prize in Microeconomics, 2016

University of Memphis, Presidential Scholarship, 2008-12

Service

MITRE Technical Economics Seminar, Organizer (2023-Present)

MITRE Economic Research Steering Group (2022-Present)

MITRE External Economics Conference, Co-Organizer and Moderator for Building Resilient Global Supply Chains Session (2023)

MITRE Economics Hiring Committee (2021-22, 2022-23, and 2023-24)

Clearances

Census Special Sworn Status, Department of Defense Top Secret, Department of Homeland Security Top Secret, Federal Aviation Administration Moderate (MBI)

Software Skills

Julia, Linux, Matlab, Python, QGIS, R, STATA. Use of several distributed high-performance computing environments

Teaching

University of Colorado, Boulder 2016-2020

Courses Taught: Principles of Microeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics

Personal

Boy Scouts of America: Eagle Scout (2008)

University of Memphis: Sigma Phi Epsilon, University of Memphis (2008, Brother Mentor 2011)

References

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University of Colorado Boulder
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University of Colorado Boulder
(303)-492-7588
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Professor Sergey Nigai
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